



AUSTRALIA · MRPBA

Registration for medical imaging

*The Medical Radiation Practice Board
route, and the checklist that goes with it.*

Ethicare Resourcing

1 chapters · October 2026

ethicareresourcing.com

What's inside

01 Registering as a medical radiation practitioner

This guide is free, and so is everything in it. Every chapter here is also on the website, where it is kept up to date — so if you are reading this some months after downloading it, check the site for anything that looks time-sensitive. Fees, tax rates and immigration settings change without much notice.

We don't print these. A PDF costs nothing to send and nothing to ship, which felt like the right answer for a company that spends its days moving people around the world.

Registering as a medical radiation practitioner

For internationally qualified diagnostic radiographers, radiation therapists and nuclear medicine technologists. Two processes run here that sound alike and are not — professional registration, and a migration skills assessment. You may need one, the other, or both, and getting them in the right order saves months. The checklist is built into the page, so nothing you tick goes out of date.



Regulator

Medical Radiation Practice Board of Australia, within the National Registration and Accreditation Scheme administered by Ahpra

Source

The Board's published requirements at [medicalradiationpracticeboard.gov.au](https://www.medicalradiationpracticeboard.gov.au). Where this page and the Board differ, the Board is right.

Status

Checked 3 October 2026 against [medicalradiationpracticeboard.gov.au](https://www.medicalradiationpracticeboard.gov.au) and [ahpra.gov.au](https://www.ahpra.gov.au) — the internationally qualified pages, the qualification assessment criteria, the National exam page and the English language skills registration standard. Fees and English scores are not printed here because they are revised.

Fees, scores & exam format

Deliberately not printed. All three are set by the Board and reviewed periodically — the English minimums changed in April 2026. Check the Board's current pages before you budget or book.

AT A GLANCE

Registration and migration are separate

The Board registers you to practise. ASMIRT assesses skills for certain visas. A positive migration assessment does not grant registration, and registration does not by itself satisfy migration.

Three divisions, one Board

Diagnostic radiographer, radiation therapist, nuclear medicine technologist — distinct registrations. You register in the division your qualification supports.

Check the fast lane first — if your division has one

Qualifications accredited by the UK's HCPC (2010–2030) or Ireland's CORU (2013–2030) are treated as substantially equivalent, generally with no portfolio assessment and no exam. This route is for **diagnostic radiographers and radiation therapists only**. The Board states it is unavailable for nuclear medicine technologists.

Registration is national; radiation licensing is not

Each state or territory licenses the use of radiation separately. You will usually need both, and employers normally guide you through the local one.

What's inside

If you remember one thing, make it Section 01. Everything else follows from getting those two processes in the right order. The checklist at the end remembers what you have ticked, on this device.

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Two separate processes

International candidates routinely conflate two completely separate assessments. They are run by different bodies, for different reasons, and the outcomes can differ.

1 · Lets you practise

Professional registration — Ahpra and the MRPBA

The Board assesses whether you meet the registration standards required to practise. Without MRPBA registration you cannot legally work in Australia as a medical radiation practitioner — whatever your visa says. It considers your formal qualifications only.

2 · For certain visas

Migration skills assessment — ASMIRT or ANZSNM

Required for some skilled-migration visa pathways, and **which body assesses you depends on your division**: ASMIRT for diagnostic radiographers and radiation therapists, ANZSNM for nuclear medicine technologists. Its purpose is immigration, not registration. It can weigh your work experience as well as your qualifications — which is why the two outcomes can differ.

The key point.

A positive migration skills assessment does not grant registration, and registration does not by itself satisfy migration requirements. Some people are approved for skilled migration and still have to meet the Board's registration requirements.

SECTION 02

The Board, and what it does

A protected profession

The MRPBA sits within the National Registration and Accreditation Scheme, administered by Ahpra. You must be registered to use the title and to work in the role.

Three divisions, registered separately

Diagnostic radiographer, radiation therapist and nuclear medicine technologist — distinct registrations with distinct education pathways. You register in the division your qualification supports.

Registration is national. Radiation licensing is not.

MRPBA registration applies Australia-wide. Using radiation is licensed separately by each state or territory, so you will usually also need a radiation-use licence where you work. Employers normally guide you through the local one.

Is my qualification recognised? → Submit to Ahpra / MRPBA → Assessment — exam if required → Registration granted → State radiation licence → Practise

SECTION 03

Is my qualification recognised?

Your pathway depends first on whether the Board already recognises your qualification. For some applicants it does, and that is the quickest route of all. For everyone else, the Board assesses your qualification portfolio and reaches one of three defined outcomes.

The fast lane — comparable regulators.

If your qualification was accredited by a regulator the Board recognises as comparable for your division, within its published date ranges, it is treated as substantially equivalent and you are qualified for general registration — generally without a portfolio assessment or the National exam. This currently includes qualifications approved by the UK's HCPC and Ireland's CORU within the Board's date ranges, plus a list of specific recognised qualifications by institution and award year. **The match has to be exact** — division, institution, award title and year. Check your own position on the Board's "Is my qualification recognised?" page before assuming either way.

If it isn't already recognised — the three outcomes

s.53(b) National Law

Substantially equivalent, or based on similar competencies

Meets the full set of criteria. The most direct route toward general registration.

s.53(c) National Law

Relevant to the profession

Meets the threshold criteria but not full equivalence. Registration is still possible, typically with an additional step such as the National examination.

Threshold not met

Neither equivalent nor relevant

The minimum threshold criteria are not met, so the qualification does not currently support registration in the division.

Recognition is always subject to the Board's assessment of your individual evidence, and the recognised lists and date ranges are reviewed periodically — confirm your position against the Board's current page.

SECTION 04

How the Board assesses a qualification

Three published criteria. Knowing them lets you assemble evidence that answers them directly rather than hoping the transcript speaks for itself.

Professional registration

Your qualification was recognised by a registration or licensing body for the profession where you trained, and you met any pre-registration assessment there — or, where there is no such body, it enabled you to practise.

2

Quality assurance and accreditation

Your programme was externally accredited against published education standards, including contemporary evidence-based practice and work-integrated clinical learning.

3

Educational level

AQF level 7 — an Australian bachelor's degree — is the bar for a *substantially equivalent* outcome. A qualification one level lower, or AQF 5 from a comparable regulator jurisdiction, can still be assessed as *relevant to the profession*. So AQF 7 is the fast-lane threshold, not the minimum to be considered at all.

The core topics the Board looks for

Across all divisions: anatomy, physiology and pathology; principles of patient care; clear communication; medical radiation physics; safe radiation practice; CT imaging; and the safe use of medicines including contrast media. Then the division's own.

Diagnostic radiographer

Projection radiography and fluoroscopy

The examinations the Board expects a diagnostic radiography or medical imaging degree to have covered.

Radiation therapist

Planning, delivery and verification

Radiation therapy planning, treatment delivery and treatment verification.

Nuclear medicine technologist

Radiopharmaceuticals, SPECT and PET

Radiopharmaceuticals and SPECT and PET imaging.

In our experience.

It is easy to assume registration is just paperwork. It isn't — it is a real assessment of whether your training meets the Australian standard. The part you control most is the part that matters most: complete, well-organised documents, sent early.

SECTION 05

The National MRP examination

It exists to confirm that practitioners whose qualifications are not assessed as substantially equivalent still meet the Australian standard before registration. Not everyone sits it.

Applicants already recognised as substantially equivalent — including those accredited by a comparable regulator within the date ranges — generally are not required to. Where a qualification is assessed as “relevant to the profession” rather than fully equivalent, you **must** pass the National exam for medical radiation practice before you can apply for registration. It is not optional for that outcome. What is uncertain is which outcome you receive, not whether the exam follows one.

Where required it is a written, knowledge-based assessment: a component common across the divisions, a component specific to yours, and Australian-context material — radiation safety legislation, the professional capabilities, culturally safe practice — alongside clinical knowledge you will already recognise.

Confirm the current format.

Structure, components and pass requirements are set by the Board and reviewed periodically. Check its National exam pages before you prepare — no format is reproduced here for exactly that reason.

SECTION 06

English language

All applicants must satisfy the MRPBA's English Language Skills Registration Standard.

It sets out the recognised ways to demonstrate English — an approved test result, or one of several exemption pathways, for example where your education was conducted and assessed in English in a recognised country.

No scores or exemption criteria are reproduced here, deliberately.

The Board reviews the standard periodically and the accepted tests and pathways change — the minimum scores did in April 2026. Read the current standard before you book any test, and if you need one, time it so the result is still valid when your application reaches the Board.

SECTION 07

Your supporting documents

A clean, complete pack is the single biggest factor within your control on timing. Certified copies — not copies of certified copies — clean high-resolution scans, consistent naming, pages complete and straight.

Passport and proof of identity

Certified, with evidence of any name change.

Degree certificate

Your qualifying award in diagnostic radiography or medical imaging, radiation therapy, or nuclear medicine technology.

Academic transcript

Full record of subjects, results and the grading system.

Clinical placement evidence

Evidence of supervised clinical training, where required.

Registration history

Your professional registration and licensure record.

Certificate of Good Standing

From each authority you are registered with, and current at submission.

Employment history and CV

Roles, dates and responsibilities, up to date, with no unexplained gaps.

English language evidence

If required under the registration standard.

Translations

Certified, supplied together with the certified original of any non-English document.

— SECTION 08

The employer-sponsored (482) pathway

Most people we support relocate under an employer-sponsored visa. On that pathway MRPBA registration is the priority — it is what allows you to practise once you arrive.

Your employer sponsors the role; the Board registers the practitioner. Both have to happen, and they are separate workstreams. An ASMIRT migration skills assessment is **not generally required** simply to obtain registration on a 482. ASMIRT's assessment is a migration step tied to particular visa pathways — most often the points-tested skilled-migration visas, 189, 190 and 491.

That is not a blanket “ASMIRT is never required.” Additional migration assessments may be needed if you later pursue permanent skilled migration or a different visa. Confirm what applies to you with your employer or a registered migration adviser — that is their call, not ours, and not the Board's.

— BEFORE YOU APPLY

Five things, in this order

Check recognition — is your qualification already on the Board's lists? Understand your pathway — recognised, portfolio assessment, and whether the exam is likely. Gather your documents. Decide your visa route — employer-sponsored 482 or skilled migration, which decides whether ASMIRT applies. Then talk to us: we confirm the pathway, help secure the role and sponsorship, and review your evidence before you submit.

— SECTION 09

Applying, and what happens next

1

Determine your eligibility

Use the Board's “Is my qualification recognised?” pathway to understand your likely route.

2

Prepare your documents

Identity, qualification, transcript, clinical evidence, registration history, good standing, CV, English.

3

Submit to Ahpra and the MRPBA

Apply for registration in your division, with the non-refundable fee.

4

Qualification and English assessment

The Board assesses your qualification; you satisfy the English standard if it applies to you.

5

National examination, if required

Where your assessment outcome requires it, you sit and pass the National exam.

6

Registration granted

Once registered, and any radiation-use licence is in place, you are cleared to practise.

7

Secure your role and start

Many Australian employers expect registration to be in place first. With it confirmed, you are ready.

How long it takes

It varies

With the completeness of your application, document verification and your circumstances. Start the slowest items — Certificates of Good Standing, verification — early.

Fees

Confirm before you budget

Ahpra and the Board set registration fees; separate fees apply to the National exam and to state radiation licences. All are reviewed periodically, so none are printed here.

Timing

Don't make irreversible moves too early

Don't resign or relocate until your registration eligibility has been assessed and confirmed. Sponsored candidates should coordinate registration and visa timelines with their employer.

— WHERE PEOPLE GET STUCK

Almost every avoidable delay traces back to one of these

Confusing registration with migration

Assuming ASMIRT is the first step. For practice, MRPBA registration is the one you need.

Assuming ASMIRT is always required

On a 482 it generally is not, for registration — but it can be for other visa pathways. Confirm yours.

Thin qualification evidence

A missing transcript or clinical-training detail, so the Board cannot judge equivalence.

Assuming you must sit the exam

Whether the National exam applies depends on your assessment outcome. Do not assume either way.

English evidence too early, or the wrong test

Check the current registration standard before booking, and time it so it stays valid.

Irreversible decisions too soon

Resigning or relocating before your registration eligibility is confirmed.

The fix for all of these

Understand the two processes, get your qualification assessed early, prepare complete documents, and confirm your visa route with your employer.

SECTION 11

The questions we are asked most

Do I need an ASMIRT assessment to register?+

So who assesses my qualification?+

Will I have to sit the National examination?+

What English evidence do I need?+

How long does registration take?+

Is registration the same as a radiation licence?+

Can I start applying for jobs before I am registered?+

Can Ethicare help with all of this?+

SECTION 12

The whole journey on one page

From first decision to first shift. Each stage links to the section that explains it; the checklist tracks the same stages.

Before you start

Separate the two processes

Registration to practise; ASMIRT for certain visas. [Section 01](#)

Before you start

Is my qualification recognised?

Division, comparable regulators, the recognised list — exact match. [Section 03](#)

Preparing

Gather and certify your documents

Identity, degree, transcript, clinical evidence, registration history, good standing, CV. [Section 07](#)

Preparing

English, if the standard requires it

Read the current standard first; time any test to stay valid. [Section 06](#)

Applying

Submit to Ahpra and the MRPBA

In your division, with the non-refundable fee. [Section 09](#)

Assessment

Qualification assessment — exam if required

One of three outcomes; the National exam follows only some of them. [Sections 04–05](#)

Decision

Registration granted

National, in your division.

Then

State radiation-use licence

Licensed separately where you will work; employers usually guide you through it.

Then

Role, sponsorship and the move

Where registration hands over to [planning your move](#).

— THE CHECKLIST

Thirty-three items, in the order you will meet them

Tick as you go. Ticks are saved on this device only — nothing is sent to us — and the list is always the current version, which a downloaded copy never is.

0 of 33 ticked

01 Understand the two processes

Getting this clear saves time and money.

- ☐ **Know that registration and migration are separate**MRPBA registration lets you practise; an ASMIRT assessment is a migration step.
- ☐ **Confirm MRPBA registration is your priority**It is the thing that allows you to work in Australia.
- ☐ **Identify your visa route**Employer-sponsored 482, or points-tested skilled migration (189, 190 or 491).
- ☐ **Check whether an ASMIRT assessment applies to you**Generally not required for registration on a 482 — confirm with your employer or adviser.

02Check whether your qualification is already recognised

The fast lane. Establish this early, because it decides how much of the rest applies.

- ☐ **Confirm your division**Diagnostic radiographer, radiation therapist or nuclear medicine technologist — the one your qualification supports.
- ☐ **Use the Board's "Is my qualification recognised?" page**It may already recognise your qualification, which changes everything below.
- ☐ **Check the comparable-regulator lists**UK HCPC (2010–2030) and Ireland CORU (2013–2030). Diagnostic radiography and radiation therapy only — this route is not available to nuclear medicine technologists.
- ☐ **Check the recognised-qualifications list**It must match exactly on division, institution, award title and year.
- ☐ **Note whether a portfolio assessment is needed**Required if your qualification is not already recognised.

03Qualification assessment, if required

What the Board weighs if it assesses your portfolio.

- ☐ **Professional registration evidence**Recognised by a registration or licensing body where you trained.
- ☐ **Quality assurance and accreditation evidence**An externally accredited programme, assessed against published standards.
- ☐ **Check your educational level against both bars**AQF level 7 is the threshold for a substantially equivalent outcome. One level lower, or AQF 5 from a comparable regulator jurisdiction, can still be assessed as relevant to the profession.
- ☐ **Core topics covered, including your division's own**Projection radiography and fluoroscopy; or treatment planning, delivery and verification; or radiopharmaceuticals, SPECT and PET.

04English language

Only if it applies to you under the registration standard.

- ☐ **Read the English Language Skills Registration Standard**Confirm the currently accepted tests and exemptions on the standard itself.
- ☐ **Provide an approved test result, if no exemption applies**Meet the minimum in every component, not just overall.
- ☐ **Check your results are still valid at submission**Time the test so it cannot expire before you apply.

05National MRP examination, if required

It depends on your assessment outcome — not everyone sits it.

- ☐ **Confirm whether the exam applies to you**Comparable-regulator and recognised-qualification applicants are generally exempt.
- ☐ **Check the current format on the Board's exam pages**A component common to all divisions and one specific to yours; structure and pass requirements are set by the Board.
- ☐ **Prepare for the Australian-context content**Radiation safety legislation, the professional capabilities, and cultural safety.

06 Supporting documents

A clean, certified pack is the biggest factor within your control.

- ☐ **Passport and certified proof of identity** Plus certified evidence of any name change.
- ☐ **Degree certificate and full academic transcript** Showing subjects, results and the grading system.
- ☐ **Clinical placement evidence** Evidence of supervised clinical training, where required.
- ☐ **Registration history and Certificate of Good Standing** From each authority you are registered with, and current at submission.
- ☐ **Employment history and up-to-date CV** Roles, dates and responsibilities, with no unexplained gaps.
- ☐ **Certified translations of non-English documents** Supplied together with the certified original.

07 Apply to Ahpra and the MRPBA

Submitting the registration application itself.

- ☐ **Complete the overseas-qualified application** Select your division.
- ☐ **Pay the application and registration fee** Non-refundable — confirm the current figures on the Board's fees page.
- ☐ **Submit a complete, well-organised pack** Certified copies, clear scans, consistent file naming.
- ☐ **Respond promptly to any Board queries** Incomplete applications are the most common cause of delay.

08 Register, licence and start

The final steps, and the one people do not expect.

- ☐ **Registration granted by the MRPBA** You are cleared to practise once registered.
- ☐ **Obtain your state radiation-use licence** Licensed separately by each state and territory. Registration alone is not enough.
- ☐ **Secure your role and confirm sponsorship** Many Australian employers expect registration to be in place first.
- ☐ **Don't make irreversible moves too early** Wait until your registration eligibility is confirmed before you resign or book anything.

Print or save as PDF

WHAT NEXT?

Registration is one part of the decision

Check my pathway Registration and eligibility only — which division, whether the ASMIRT assessment applies, and which state radiation licence sits on top. **How registration works in Australia** For every profession — Ahpra, the boards, the sequence, English and timelines. **Medical imaging in Australia** The family of professions, and the pages for each. **Radiographer** What the work is like, indicative pay under the state agreements, where the departments are. **Radiation therapist** The work, pay and places for the radiation therapy division. **Nuclear medicine technologist** The work, pay and places for the nuclear medicine division. **Plan your move** Registration, visas, family and the order to do it in — personalised, saved in your browser.

HOW WE HELP

We line the two processes up so they don't hold each other up

We help secure the role and the sponsorship, and we guide the preparation and timing of your registration, flagging issues while they are still easy to fix. The registration decision always rests with the Medical Radiation Practice Board of Australia.

Talk to Ethicare

The Board's own site ↗